

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY

ATTACK REPORT

Nokoyawa 2.0: A Reworked Rust-Based Ransomware

Date of Publication

December 22, 2022

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2022312

Summary

First appeared: February 2022

Attack Region: Worldwide

Attack: The Rust-based Nokoyawa ransomware 2.0 culminates in an attack that includes data exfiltration and other impacts.

Attack Regions



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Attack Details

#1

Nokoyawa is a 64-bit Windows-based ransomware family that first appeared in early February 2022. The threat group behind Nokoyawa conducts double-extortion ransomware attacks, first stealing data from companies, then encrypting files, and demanding a ransom payment. The 2.0 version of the Rust-based Nokoyama ransomware was revised in late September 2022.

#2

To increase file encryption performance and evade antivirus and EDR software, Nokoyawa was rewritten in the Rust programming language using ECC with Curve25519 and Salsa20. The new variant gives threat actors runtime flexibility through a configuration parameter given via the command line.

Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actors and attacks through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5's Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the 'Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs' & 'Indicators of Compromise (IoC)' on the following pages.

Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0007</u> Discovery	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control
<u>TA0010</u> Exfiltration	<u>TA0040</u> Impact	<u>T1027</u> Obfuscated Files or Information	<u>T1070</u> Indicator Removal
<u>T1135</u> Network Share Discovery	<u>T1552</u> Unsecured Credentials	<u>T1560</u> Archive Collected Data	<u>T1573</u> Encrypted Channel
<u>T1486</u> Data Encrypted for Impact	<u>T1001</u> Data Obfuscation		

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	7095beafff5837070a89407c1bf3c6acf8221ed786e0697f6c578d4c3de0efd6 47c00ac29bbaee921496ef957adaf5f8b031121ef0607937b003b6ab2a895a12 259f9ec10642442667a40bf78f03af2fc6d653443cce7062636eb750331657c4

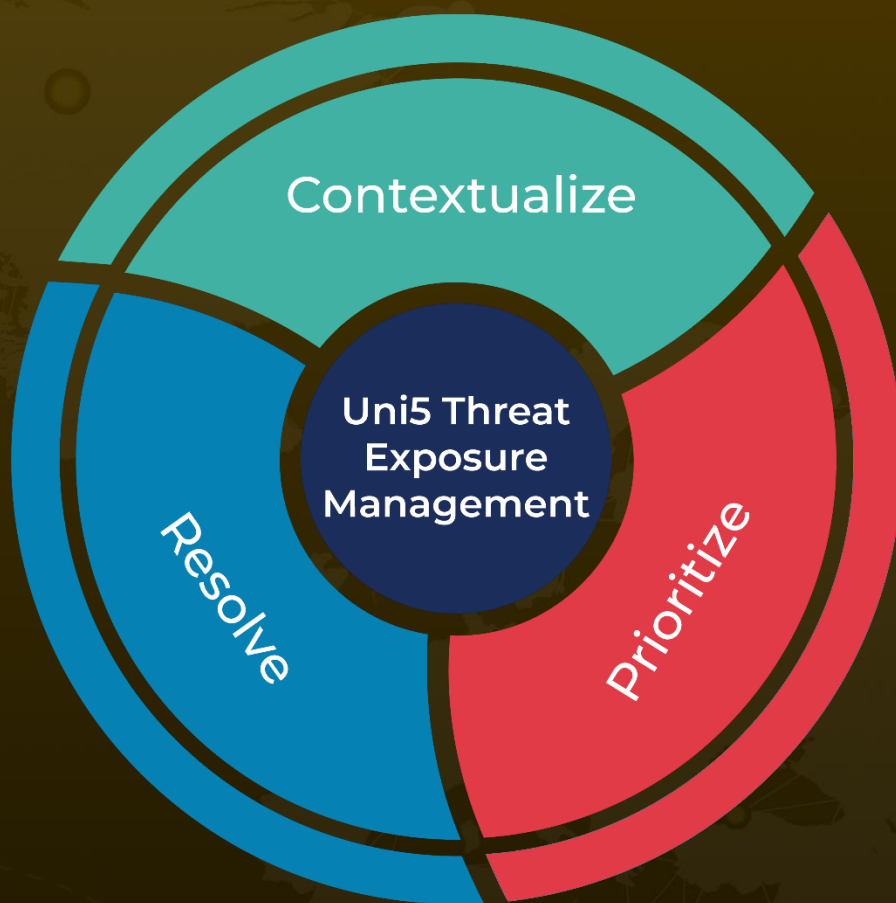
References

<https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/security-research/nokoyawa-ransomware-rust-or-bust>

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

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